Arunachal Dam Watch

What exists, what is coming, how much land and forest it takes, and what has gone wrong. Compiled from government records, clearance papers and news reports up to 1 Nov 2026.

About **2,365** MW of large hydro runs today, plus **140.61** MW of small hydro, and **33** more projects are planned.

Large hydro (over 25 MW)

2,365

MW running now; Subansiri Lower counts only its 5 finished units of 8

Projects existing

4

large hydro (over 25 MW) operating or partly operating: Kameng, Panyor Lower, Pare and Subansiri Lower

Small hydro (under 25 MW)

140.61

MW installed, per Ministry of Power (Dec 2024). There's no official list or count of these plants, so how many exist is not known. Not included in the other figures.

Projects coming up

33

19,165 MW planned, per state govt; 19 have public records below

Forest land taken

8,471

hectares in Arunachal, projects built or under construction; Kameng's figure is a 2003 estimate

Forest land sought

5,898

hectares, projects approved or in clearances

Trees cleared for felling

324K

permitted for projects built or underway; only Dibang has a published count

Trees to be felled

2.8M

in projects awaiting clearance or construction

People affected by incidents

106.8K

340 villages flooded; dam releases, failed flood control and site disasters only

Disasters linked to dams

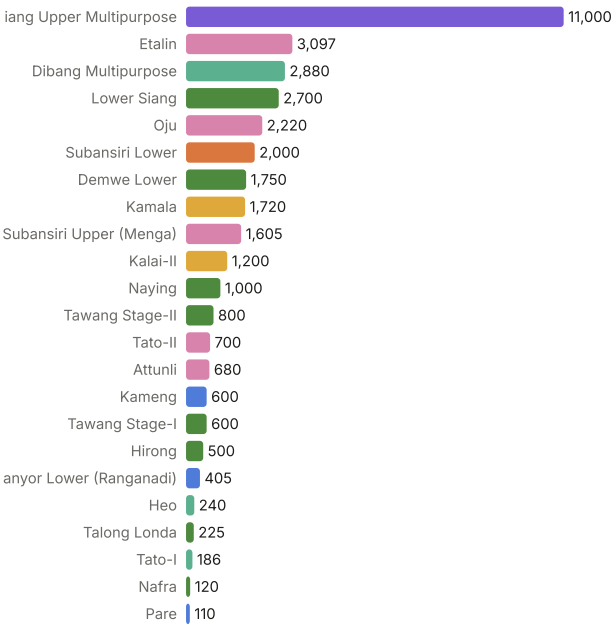
9

plus 7 site failures (warning signs)

Capacity by project

Megawatts, every project found, coloured by stage.

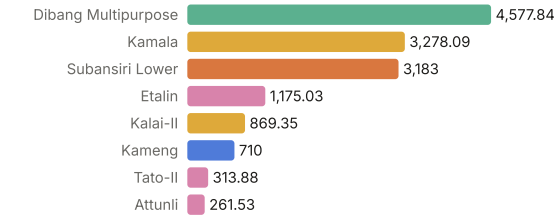
Operating · Partly operating · Under construction · Approved · Clearances in progress · Concurred, not started · Survey stage



Forest land by project

Hectares of forest diverted or sought, for every project in the capacity chart. Projects with no published figure are listed at the bottom as data not available.

Operating · Partly operating · Under construction · Approved · Clearances in progress · Concurred, not started · Survey stage

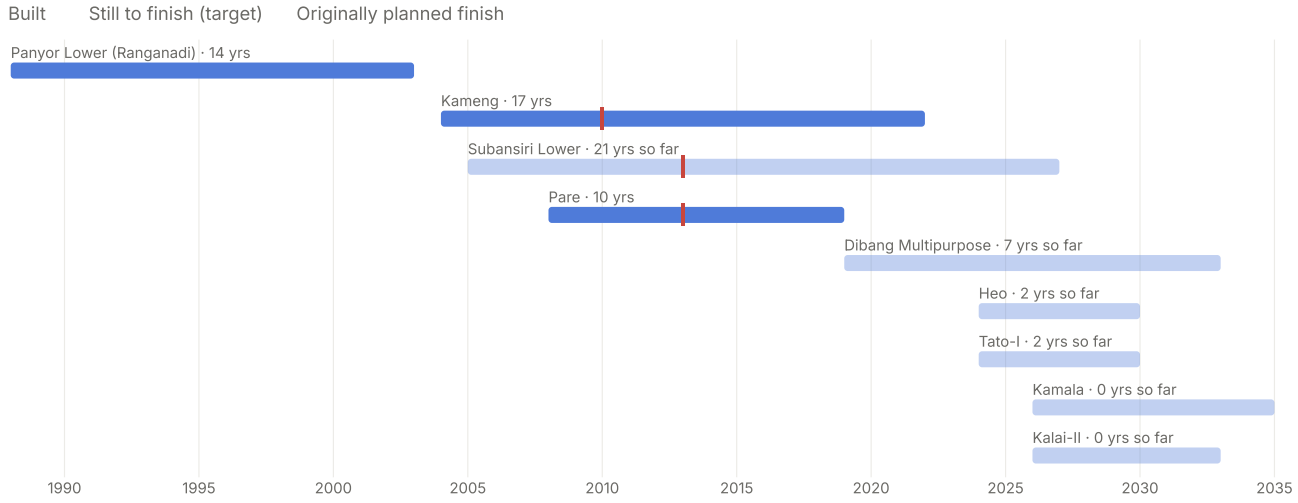


Data not available (15 projects)

- iang Upper Multipurpose — Data not available
- Lower Siang — Data not available
- Oju — Data not available
- Demwe Lower — Data not available
- Subansiri Upper (Menga) — Data not available
- Naying — Data not available
- Tawang Stage-II — Data not available
- Tawang Stage-I — Data not available
- Hirong — Data not available
- anyor Lower (Ranganadi) — Data not available
- Heo — Data not available
- Talong Londa — Data not available
- Tato-I — Data not available
- Nafra — Data not available
- Pare — Data not available

How long each dam took, and what it cost

Bars run from approval or start of work to completion (solid) or target date (faded). The tick marks the originally planned finish. Costs in Rs crore.



Project	Stage	Start	Counted from	Planned finish	Finished / target	Years taken	Years late	Original cos
Panyor Lower (Ranganadi)	Operating	1988	Start of work	Data not available	2002	14	Data not available	Data not a
Kameng	Operating	2004	Approval	2009	2021	17	12	
Pare	Operating	2008	Approval	2012	2018	10	6	
Subansiri Lower	Partly operating	2005	Start of work	2012	2026	21 so far	14	
Dibang Multipurpose	Under construction	2019	Approval	2032	2032	7 so far	not yet due	

Project	Stage	Start	Counted from	Planned finish	Finished / target	Years taken	Years late	Original cos
Heo	Under construction	2024	Approval	2029	2029	2 so far	not yet due	
Tato-I	Under	2024	Approval	2029	2029	2 so far	not yet due	

Data not available means no reliable public figure was found. "Years taken" for unfinished projects counts years so far, to 2026. Panyor Lower and Subansiri Lower are counted from the start of work, the rest from approval, so their years are not strictly comparable. Costs are in the rupees of their own year, not adjusted for inflation.

All projects

Data not available marks figures not found in a reliable source. Tree counts are official figures from clearance papers: "cleared for felling" for projects built or under construction, "to be felled" for those still seeking approval. They are permitted or estimated counts, not trees confirmed cut. "Proposed" is the earliest documented step found (often CEA approval of the project report, so the idea may be older); "Started" is the start of work or government approval; dates and notes in amber are estimates or have gaps. Use the filters and sort controls below, or click a column heading to sort.

Stage: All stages | District: All districts | Developer: All developers | Sort by: Capacity (MW) | Descending ↓ | Reset

Showing **23** of 23 projects. Projects with no figure for the sorted column always go to the bottom.

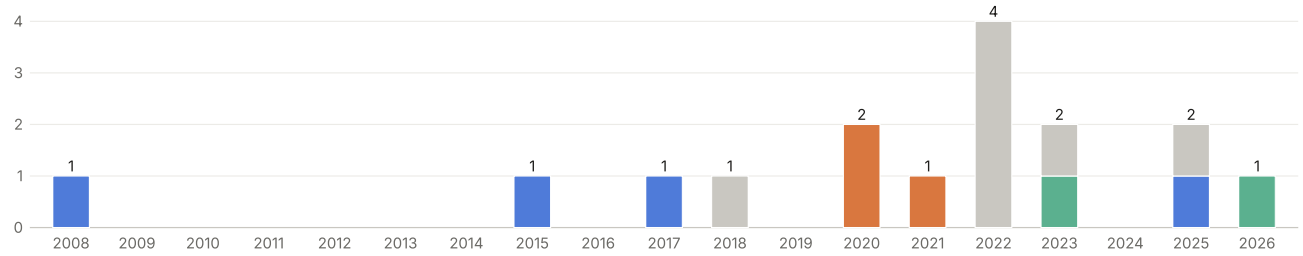
Project	District	Stage	River	Developer	MW	Dam height (m)	Total land (ha)	
Talong Londa	East Kameng	Concurred, not started	Data not available	Data not available	225	Data not available	Data not available	D
Tato-I	Shi Yomi	Under construction	Yarjep	NEEPCO	186	Data not available	Data not available	D
Nafra	West Kameng	Concurred, not started	Data not available	Data not available	120	Data not available	Data not available	D
Pare	Papum Pare	Operating	Dikrong	NEEPCO	110	63	Data not available	D

Disasters and site failures by year

Disasters are events that harmed people, land or the river beyond the project site. Site failures stayed within the site but show unstable ground or weak construction. Worker accidents are not included.

Flood from dam release | Flood the dam failed to control | Landslide or failure at project | Site failure (warning sign)

> For many incidents there is no official count of people affected, houses lost, livestock killed or crops damaged, and for some even deaths are uncertain. Project developers rarely publish incident reports, and district flood figures often don't separate a dam release from rain. The real scale of many incidents is likely larger than shown here, so treat these numbers as a minimum.



Disasters linked to dams

Floods caused or worsened by dam releases, floods a dam failed to hold back, and landslides or failures at projects that hit people or the river. Loss of life is noted in each description. Use the filters and sort controls, or click a column heading to sort. Not reported marks a figure no one published. Subansiri Lower sits on the Assam border, and Panyor Lower floods hit Lakhimpur in Assam.

Project: All projects | Type: All types | Sort by: Date | Descending ↓ | Reset

Showing **9** of 9 disasters. Disasters with no figure for the sorted column always go to the bottom.

When	Project	Type	People affected	Villages flooded	Houses destroyed	In relief camps	Crops hit (ha)	River disruption
31 May 2025	Panyor Lower (Ranganadi)	Flood from dam release	Not reported	243				
27 Oct 2023	Subansiri Lower	Landslide or failure at project	Not reported	Not reported				Ran dry ~12 hours
26 Aug 2021	Subansiri Lower	Flood the dam failed to control	91,436	97			4,084.2	
Jul 2020 (3rd week)	Subansiri Lower	Flood the dam failed to control	Not reported	Not reported				
27 May – 19 Jun 2020	Subansiri Lower	Flood the dam failed to control	Not reported	Not reported				

Site failures: warning signs

Landslides, wall collapses and leaks at project sites that didn't harm anyone outside, but point to unstable ground or weak construction.

When	Project	Type	What happened	Source
11 Jun 2025	Subansiri Lower	Wall collapse	Guard wall beneath Spillway Gate Block 6 washed away; NDSA ordered extra grouting, delaying commissioning.	Assam Tribune
3 Apr 2023	Subansiri Lower	Landslide	Landslide damaged part of the dam works; workers evacuated.	SANDRP (citing India Today NE)
12 Oct 2022	Subansiri Lower	Landslide	Large part of the hill fell onto the river diversion course; work suspended.	SANDRP (citing NE Now)
25 Sep 2022	Subansiri Lower	Wall collapse / flood	Temporary guard wall collapsed; floodwater entered the powerhouse; workers evacuated.	Arunachal Times; SANDRP

When	Project	Type	What happened	Source
16 Sep 2022	Subansiri Lower	Sinkhole	Large sinkhole opened on the left bank, damaging diversion tunnel 2.	SANDRP (citing India Today NE, NE Now)
1 Apr 2022	Subansiri Lower	Wall collapse	Powerhouse protection wall partially collapsed; CEA asked NHPC to reassess slope stability and worker safety.	Sentinel Assam; Arunachal Times
12 Mar 2018	Kameng	Penstock leakage	Penstock leaked at several places during first water filling, blamed on faulty welding; commissioning delayed.	Arunachal Times; CEA

What this does and doesn't cover

- The land total is a floor, not a full count. No official source adds up land under all existing dams; operating projects like Panyor Lower and Pare have no published land figures I could find.
- Project counts, charts and tables cover large hydro only (over 25 MW), the line the Central Electricity Authority uses. Small hydro is shown as one figure: the Ministry of Power's installed capacity as of 31 Dec 2024. No official list or count of the small plants was found, so the number of plants, their land use and any incidents at them are not covered. Dikshi (24 MW) and Khangtang (7 MW), which the state lists as commissioned, are among them.
- The state's own list of commissioned projects (5, Mar 2026) differs from the "Projects existing" count because it includes those two small plants and leaves out Subansiri Lower, which sits on the Assam border.
- Flood counts for 2017 and 2021 are district-wide, so they include damage from rain as well as from the dam. They are kept because a dam that releases or fails to hold back water can make a flood worse.
- "Forest land taken" counts only Arunachal's share; Subansiri Lower diverted another 816 ha in Assam.
- The state counts 33 projects coming up; the table lists only those with named public records.
- Worker accidents at construction sites are left out: this dashboard tracks harm to people, land and rivers beyond the projects.
- The disaster and site-failure lists rely partly on SANDRP, an advocacy group that tracks dam accidents; each entry points back to the news report it cites. Loss of life, where mentioned, is as reported by local media, not an official toll.
- Dam heights for Dibang (278 m, cut from 288 m) and Siang Upper (~300 m) are as reported; Siang Upper is still at survey stage.

Sources

Every report and record the figures on this page come from.

Government and official records

- PIB – Lok Sabha reply on NE hydro projects, Dec 2023
- PIB – Ranganadi project commissioned, 2002
- News on Air – CCEA approves Heo and Tato-I, Nov 2024
- CEA – Status of under-execution hydro projects (Kameng)
- CEA – Schemes concurred, status of clearances
- MoEFCC – 47th EAC minutes, Kamala project, Jan 2026
- MoEFCC – Etalin forest diversion proposal
- NHPC – Dibang six-monthly environment report
- THDC – Kalai-II project details
- IIPA – Subansiri Upper social impact report
- Energetica India – CCEA approves Kamala and Kalai-II, Apr 2026
- Ministry of Power – Rajya Sabha reply: state-wise small hydro capacity, 31 Dec 2024
- CEA/CBIP (2022) – NE hydro status, CEA concurrence dates
- Business Standard – 12 projects re-allotted to PSUs, Aug 2023
- Civils Daily – Naying concurrence and targets

Projects, land and forest

- Arunachal Times – 33 hydropower projects coming up, Mar 2026
- Indian PSU – Fifth Subansiri Lower unit commissioned
- NE Now – Subansiri Lower forest and reservoir figures
- NE Now – Subansiri Lower submergence area
- The Wire – Dibang land, submergence and trees
- Arunachal Times – Dibang dam height reduced
- EastMojo – Kamala: 23 lakh trees
- Power Peak Digest – Kamala people affected
- NE Now – Kalai-II and Attunli forest diversion
- TEI Times – Kalai-II forest clearance
- EastMojo – Etalin forest approval
- Hindustan Times – Forest nod to Tato-II
- Ensure IAS – Subansiri Upper forest and trees
- Civils Daily – Oju project
- EastMojo – Siang Upper dam height
- Mongabay India – Siang Upper villages at risk
- Arunachal Times – Pare dam height
- Global Energy Monitor – Lower Siang location

Disasters, failures and impact

- Assam Times – Ranganadi floods 2008, 2017, 2025
- Assam Tribune – Ranganadi dam release floods villages
- NE Now – Ranganadi floods since 2008
- Scroll – Lakhimpur flood, Jul 2017
- Dialogue Earth – NEEPCO dam safety record
- Arunachal Times – Kameng penstock leaks, 2018
- SANDRP – Repeated disasters at Subansiri, 2020–2022
- Sentinel Assam – Subansiri flood hits 97 villages, Aug 2021
- Sentinel Assam – CEA concerns over Subansiri guard walls
- SANDRP – Subansiri landslide, Apr 2023
- Arunachal Times – Subansiri landslide blocks river, Oct 2023
- SANDRP – Subansiri runs dry, Oct 2023
- India Today NE – 230+ villages flooded, May 2025
- Assam Tribune – Subansiri guard wall collapse, Jun 2025
- SANDRP – Panyor colony flash flood, Jun 2026
- Assam Tribune – Panyor flood houses and missing, Jun 2026

- EastMojo – Nafra agreement with NEEPCO, Aug 2021
- Renewable Energy World – Pare agreement, 2006
- SANDRP – Dibang foundation stone, 2008
- News Arena – Dibang construction begins, Sept 2025
- Renewable Watch – Heo and Tato-I foundation stones, Sept 2025
- Scroll – Siang Upper proposed by NITI Aayog, 2017
- Power Peak Digest – Oju clearance and build time
- CERC – Pare tariff order: approval, delay and completion cost
- CERC – Ranganadi revised cost
- Swarajya – Kameng approval, cost overrun and commissioning
- India Today NE – Subansiri Lower 13-year delay
- Arunachal Times – Subansiri Lower cost rises to Rs 26,000 crore
- Business Standard – Kamala and Kalai-II costs
- Water Power Magazine – Dibang completion target
- India Today NE – Demwe Lower in Lohit district
- India Today NE – Naying in Shi Yomi district
- Mountain Echo – Hirong among Shi Yomi projects
- GMR Group – Talong Londa in East Kameng
- Sentinel Assam – Nafra in West Kameng
- The Ecologist Asia (2003) – Kameng land requirement

Data compiled from public records, clearance papers and news reports up to 1 Nov 2026. Figures are a minimum where reporting is incomplete; see sources above.